Building a Workforce with Paperclip

Mode 2 Phase 3 (Scale the Workforce), Chapter 3/9 — Revision & Viva-Prep Cheatsheet (English + Roman Urdu)
Source: agentfactory.panaversity.org/docs/workforce-with-paperclip-crash-course

EN: Paperclip is the operating system for running an AI-agents company. You (the board) -> your general agent -> Paperclip (holds the company, wakes employees) -> CEO (plans+delegates, never does the work itself) -> Team (specialists who actually do it).
Roman Urdu: Paperclip AI-agents-company chalane ka operating system hai. Aap (board) -> apna general agent -> Paperclip (company hold karta, employees jagata) -> CEO (plan+delegate karta, khud kaam nahi karta) -> Team (specialists jo kaam karte).

1. Setup + CEO + Strategy

- Company = goal + agent-team + task-board + budget. CEO is the first hire, reports directly to the board (no manager) -- you approve the CEO too, that's the whole point.
- Heartbeat = scheduled work-time. First heartbeat, CEO drafts strategy into in_review and does NOT proceed without sign-off.

2. Tasks + Hiring + Budget

- A task flows backlog -> todo -> in_progress -> in_review -> done. A sharp CEO files a hire-request BEFORE creating tasks that need that role.
- Best practice: pause the CEO's heartbeat after approving a hire -- 'autonomy is a grant, you can take it back.'
- Every agent carries a spending cap: warning at 80%, PAUSE at 100%.

3. Audit Trail + Workspace + Monthly Operating

- Audit trail = activity_log (per-action row) + cost_events (dollar story) in embedded Postgres -- any outsider can reconstruct history in seconds. actor_type (user vs agent) separates human decisions from agent actions.
- Workspace = a real folder/git repo the company points to, so the agent writes real files, not just comments.
- **Monthly audit** walks every hire/config/schedule/approval since last audit, flagging anything without explicit sign-off -- running a company is a standing responsibility, not one-time setup.

Key Terms Cheatsheet

One line each — English + Roman Urdu.

Term	English	Roman Urdu
Paperclip	The operating system for running an AI-agents company.	AI-agents-company chalane ka operating system.
CEO (first hire)	Plans and delegates, reports to the board, never does the work itself.	Plan/delegate karta, board ko report karta, khud kaam nahi karta.
Heartbeat	Scheduled work-time when an agent acts.	Scheduled work-time jab agent act karta.
actor_type column	Separates human decisions (user) from agent actions in the audit log.	Human decisions (user) ko agent actions se audit log mein separate karta.
Monthly audit	Walks all hires/config/schedules/approvals since last audit for unsigned changes.	Pichle audit se sab hires/config/schedules/approvals walk karta, unsigned changes dhoondta.

Quick Self-Check

Question	Answer
Why must you approve the CEO agent too, not just lower-level hires?	That's the whole point of the model -- even the first hire needs board sign-off, nothing in the company runs on inherited trust.
Why pause the CEO's heartbeat right after approving a new hire?	Autonomy is a grant that can be taken back -- pausing forces a deliberate re-check before the new hire starts acting.
What happens to an agent at 100% of its spending cap?	It pauses -- 80% only triggers a warning, 100% stops spending entirely.
What are the common 'loose knobs' a monthly audit catches?	Budget-cap-less hires that inherited a ceiling, overloaded agents, drifted config files, and tasks parked in_review.

Where This Leads / Sources

Leads to: A Self-Expanding Workforce with Paperclip (the next, growing version). Full 7 scenarios + monthly operating cadence.

Source: docs/workforce-with-paperclip-crash-course/ (this repo), content originally via Zia Tutor AI connector.